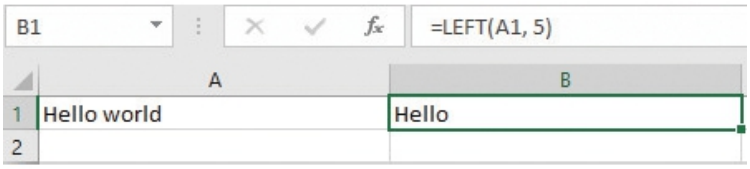
- **Functions for extracting text characters**
  The main functions for extracting text characters are *LEFT*, *RIGHT* and *MID*. Let's have a look at them one by one.
  The LEFT function can extract a certain number of characters at the beginning of a text string. The correct syntax of the function is:

=LEFT(text; num_chars)

The "*text*" argument represents the text string from which we want to extract characters, while the "*num_chars*" is the number of characters to be extracted.
For instance, if cell A1 had the text "hello world," the first 5 characters could be extracted with the following formula:

=LEFT(A1, 5)

The result will be "*hello*".



The *RIGHT* function, on the contrary, is useful for extracting characters placed at the end of the text string. The correct syntax of the function is:

=RIGHT(text, num_chars)

Using the previous example, the last 5 characters can be extracted with the following formula:

=RIGHT(A1, 5)

The result will be "*world*".

The *MID* function enables you to extract characters starting from a specific position within the text string. The correct syntax of the function is:

=MID(text; start_num;num_chars)

The "*text*" argument indicates the text string from which you want to